

Section B Option 2: Education

This option focuses on debates in contemporary society through a detailed study of education. Learners have the opportunity to explore the role of education in society and patterns of educational achievement. Learners can also reflect on global educational inequalities as well as inequalities within the contemporary UK. It aims to give an understanding of different theoretical approaches to the study of education.

Key questions	Content	Learners should:
1. What is the role of education in society?	Theoretical views of the role of education: • functionalism • Marxism • liberal • social democratic • New Right • feminism Theoretical explanations of the relationship between education and work: • functionalism • Marxism • New Right	consider work-based training and vocationalism post-1988 as well as the traditional theoretical explanations of the relationship between education and work.
2. What are the patterns and trends of educational inequalities?	Differential educational achievement by: • social class • ethnicity • gender Educational inequalities in a global context: • the global 'gender apartheid' in education • the disparity in educational provision around the world	consider the inter-relationship between social class, gender and ethnicity.

Key questions	Content	Learners should:
3. How can differential educational achievement be explained?	Explanations for differential educational achievement: • inside and outside school factors • structural, material and cultural factors • theoretical approaches • functionalism • Marxism • interactionism • social democratic • feminism • New Right	consider differential educational achievement in relation to social class, gender and ethnicity.
4. How has the UK education system changed?	The diversity of educational provision Government policies from 1988 onwards, including vocational and work-based training Ideological influences on government educational policy: • New Right • social democratic The impact of educational policies on: • competition, diversity and choice • raising standards • equality and equality of opportunity	consider different types of educational institutions, including different types of school. consider a range of policies from 1988 onwards. Any contemporary educational policy will be rewarded where relevant. explore the links between educational policies and ideological influences. consider educational policy in relation to gender, class and ethnicity.